

their rates to \$105. Annual passes are much more cost-effective, and become even cheaper the more you visit.

If you're buying a family pass, you'll probably also want to buy one of the park's special cups for discounted refills. These are usually \$5-\$10 per cup for your very first purchase, but only \$1-\$2 a refill. This is a great deal since sodas and food in general are so expensive anyway. Just wash the cups at home and bring them with you every time you visit.

Also, taking food into parks can be taboo, but sometimes they let you through with a few snacks anyway. While I think it's okay to splurge on outside meals if you've budgeted for them, we prefer to save by packing our own and avoiding the greasy food that's bound to make us sick on the next rollercoaster!

4. CHECK THE COMMUNITY CALENDAR

One look at your local newspaper or city website, and you'll find tons of free events available in your community. Find the community calendar and put a few activities on your list to do as a family. Many are free, but the ones that do cost money are sometimes only a few dollars apiece.

Examples of community events are:

- Nature Walks
- Movies in the Park
- Local Festivals
- 5K's
- Parades
- Family Fun Nights